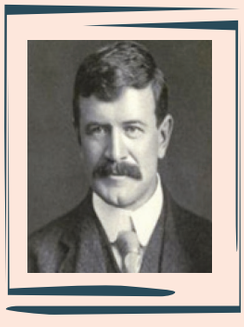
picture–something which (mad though it seems) would have looked like me. I wanted something that would **depict** my face as Heaven gave it to me, humble though the gift may have been. I wanted something that my friends might keep after my death, to **reconcile** them to my loss. It seems that I was mistaken. What I wanted is no longer done. Go on, then, with your brutal work. Take your negative, or whatever it is you call it–dip it in sulphide, bromide, oxide, cowhide–anything you like–remove the eyes, correct the mouth, adjust the face, restore the lips, reanimate the necktie and reconstruct the waistcoat. Coat it with an inch of gloss, shade it, **emboss** it, gild it, till even you acknowledge that it is finished. Then when you have done all that–keep it for yourself and your friends. They may value it. To me it is but a worthless **bauble.**" I broke into tears and left.

## About the Author

Stephen P. H. Butler Leacock – FRSC (1869 – 1944) was a Canadian teacher, Political Scientist, Writer and Humourist. He was educated at Upper Canada College in Toronto and the University of Toronto from which he graduated in 1891. He received a Fellowship in Political Economy and took his Ph.D. in 1903. Between the years 1915 and 1925, he was the best known English speaking humorist in the world. He is known for his light humour along with criticism of people's follies. *Sunshine Sketches of a Little Town, Arcadian Adventures, With the Idle Rich, Economic Prosperity in the British Empire, The Dawn of Canadian History, Moonbeams From the Larger Lunacy, The Unsolved Riddle of Social Justice, My Discovery of England, Wet, Wit and Dry Humour* are some of his brilliant writings.



## Glossary:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **drooping** | – | bending |
| **unwarrantable** | – | illegal, wrongful |
| **pursuits** | – | quest |
| **frantic** | – | mad, desperate |
| **grave** | – | serious |
| **boundless** | – | limitless |
| **ceased** | – | stopped |
| **trifle** | – | bit |
| **staggering** | – | shaking or vibrating |
| **animation** | – | excitement |
| **beckoned** | – | called |
| **superficies** | – | surface / outer face |
| **withering scorn** | – | disapproving hatred |
| **depict** | – | show, give a picture of |
| **reconcile** | – | to comfort and heal |
| **emboss** | – | cause to bulge out |
| **bauble** | – | a thing of no value |

**1. Based on your understanding of the story, answer the following questions in two or three sentences each**

a. Why did the author go to the photo studio?

b. Describe the photographer.

c. Bring out the significance of what Leacock was reading at the photographer's.



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